

Descriptive details

Readers won't be able to imagine something unless they are given details. By selecting particular words, writers can add extra information and make a sentence more descriptive.

She reached for a slice of cake and put it in her mouth.

△ Lacking detail

This sentence doesn't tell the reader very much about the scene.

Using this word is a more precise way to describe the big slice.

She grabbed a wedge of sticky, delicious chocolate cake and stuffed it in her mouth.

△ Precise vocabulary

Sometimes it's better to use precise vocabulary that includes description within the words themselves.

She reached quickly for a big slice of sticky, delicious cake and eagerly put it in her mouth.

△ Adjectives and adverbs

The addition of adjectives and adverbs instantly makes the sentence more evocative.

She tentatively reached for a sliver of fattening cake and sneakily popped it in her mouth.

△ Different choices

By using different descriptive words, a writer can give a sentence a totally different feel.

Figurative language

Figurative language is an exaggerated style of writing that draws comparisons between things to create a more vivid description.

Simile

A simile compares one thing to another by using the words *as* or *like*.

Her cheeks were pink **like** strawberries.

Metaphor

A metaphor is a word or phrase that describes something as if it were something else.

A **wave** of terror washed over him.

Personification

Personification is when human actions or feelings are given to objects or ideas.

The wind **screamed** and **howled**.

Onomatopoeia

Onomatopoeia is when a writer uses words that mimic the sound they stand for.

The leaves **crunched** underfoot.